

all by deliberating on a suggested common framework to build, deploy and operate digital public infrastructure (DPI) along with consensus on initiatives like GDPR, which will host various DPIs on open-source platforms. The Trade and Investment working group is also negotiating on various aspects of digitalisation such as trade documents and platforms for MSMEs and start-ups.



Any other issues you would like to highlight?

A major achievement has been pushing for the inclusion

destinations, such as at the meeting in Hampi. It has also given a chance to Tier II cities to host meetings of this stature. Could you throw some light on how this was planned and implemented?

The credit for this lies completely with our PM. It was his vision to adopt a whole-of-India approach and move beyond the usual metropolitan cities as meeting venues. We have hosted over 140 meetings, welcoming more than 18,000 delegates hailing from over 115 different nationalities to G20 meetings and



We are pushing for commitments on development and climate finance, particularly leveraging private capital

of the African Union as a permanent member of the G20. Prime Minister [Narendra] Modi is at the forefront of ensuring that the concerns of the Global South are well represented under India's presidency. The inclusion of the African Union will be a phenomenal step in this direction and it has already received an overwhelming response from many G20 countries.



Showcasing millets as a modern diet superfood has also been an achievement for India's presidency. What is your take?

It was PM Modi's vision to introduce millets to global palates and this has received a phenomenal response. The presidency also coincides with the International Year of Millets and this has helped us highlight the value addition of these supergrains even more. The millet counters at all G20 meetings across the country have been greatly appreciated by the visiting guests. Indian chefs have whipped up delicious preparations of local as well global cuisines using millets. We have also been able to gather global consensus on the International Millets and Other Ancient Grains Research Initiative within the agriculture working group.



The G20 presidency has also given India a chance to showcase its cultural heritage as well as tourist

associated events. All states and union territories have had an experience of the G20 fervour. The visiting delegates have witnessed India's rich cultural and natural diversity and heritage across the length and breadth of the country. There are many places that would not have otherwise been on the itinerary of visitors from abroad but thanks to the G20 presidency, we have put so many of these locations on the global map now. I am confident that the experiences delegates have taken back with them will boost tourism in these pockets of India.



What has been your personal journey as India's Sherpa to the G20? You have travelled across the country, held innumerable meetings, and managed multiple issues. How did you tackle so many things?

All G20 members, invitee countries and international organisations have been greatly collaborative. We are all on the same page when it comes to accelerating developmental priorities and ensuring resilient and sustainable economic growth for the world. Listening to multiple perspectives and country positions on the most pressing issues of our times has been a steep but rewarding learning curve for me. **BT**

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